XYZ - Technology Services

Information Asset Management Procedure

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Owner: Chief Digital Officer (CDO)

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1. Purpose

This procedure aims to achieve and maintain appropriate protection of organizational information assets related to the scope mentioned below at XYZ - Technology Services (hereafter referred to as "XYZ-TS"). This procedure also ensures that information receives an appropriate level of protection. The information asset classification scheme and associated guidelines shall consider the following:

- The type of information asset (hardware, software, human and other information resources);
- The criticality of the information asset to XYZ -TS;
- The information asset value is based on confidentiality, integrity, and availability.
- The impact of a security breach; and
- Methods of handling the information asset (storage, transmission, processing, and destruction).
- Ensure that there is no unauthorized disclosure of sensitive information (e.g., Sensitive client information, sensitive passwords);
- Prevent over or under-engineering of security controls, thereby reducing potential operational over-expenditures and unnecessary stress on XYZ-TS resources;
- Restrict unauthorized modification of data; and
- Improve the enforcement of access control procedures.

1.1. Review

Policies, Procedures, Guidelines, and Standards contained in this policy will be reviewed annually or whenever a significant change arises applicable to this policy of XYZ-TS.

1.2. Enforcement

All stakeholders (including staff and third-party vendors) accessing XYZ-TS's information systems shall comply with the Information Security Policies. Such personnel should be required to execute an agreement with XYZ-TS agreeing to abide by the Policy.

1.3. Exceptions

Where warranted, approval for exceptions or deviations from the policies will be provided only after an appropriate assessment of the risks arising from providing the exception. This assessment will be conducted by the IS Officer, and submitted to the Information Security Management Committee (ISMC) for approval.

Exceptions will be agreed on a case-by-case basis, upon an official request made by the information asset owner. These may arise, for example, because of business circumstances,

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conditions, practical limitations, or legal reasons existing at any point in time. All exceptions must be submitted to the ISMC.

Approval for the exception will be provided by ISMC. The IS Officer will review all exceptions annually for validity and continuity.

2. Distribution

This is an internal document and should only be shared with employees of XYZ-TS and intended parties determined by the Information Security Officer (ISO).

3. Scope

This asset classification scheme applies to all information assets within XYZ-TS's Information Security Management System (ISMS) scope and boundaries, whether stored or transmitted (inside or outside XYZ-TS premises, in physical or digital form), which is in the possession or under the control of XYZ-TS.

Confidential information entrusted to the company by its customers, suppliers, business partners, and others shall be protected with an appropriate information classification scheme as per the contractual agreement (confidentiality or non-disclosure agreement) with the involved party.

4. Definition

Information	Information is an asset that, like other important business assets, is essential to an organization's business and consequently needs to be suitably protected. Information can be stored in many forms, including digital form (e.g. data files stored on electronic or optical media), material form (e.g. paper), as well as unrepresented information in the form of knowledge of the employees. Information may be transmitted by various means including courier, electronic or verbal communication. Whatever form information takes, or how the information is transmitted, it always needs appropriate protection.
Information Assets	Anything that has value to the organization.
Sensitive Information	Data must be protected from unauthorized access.
Information security	Preservation of confidentiality, integrity, and availability of information; in addition, other properties, such as authenticity, accountability, nonrepudiation, and reliability can also be involved.

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Confidentiality	The property that information is not made available or disclosed to unauthorized individuals, entities, or procedures
Integrity	The property of safeguarding the accuracy and completeness of assets.
Digital Data	Nontangible information assets. (Digital documents)
Physical assets	Tangible information assets. (Paper documents, backup tapes, etc.)
Human Assets	Human Resources is the most valuable asset to any organization.

5. Asset Management System (AMS)

- All information assets, hardware, softcopy/hardcopy documents and people shall be recorded and maintained in the "AMS".
- XYZ Asset Management System (AMS) records all the information assets by the Central Asset Management Team (CAM).
- The CAM team outlines and conducts the specific processes and tasks that are mentioned in the ***Central Asset Management Process Guidelines***.
- The information asset owner will value and classify the asset based on the risk assessment methodology.
- Physical assets (hardware devices, hardcopy documents, etc.) shall be labeled with a code according to the classification, which identifies the asset in the AMS. Refer to the 8.6 Classification Labeling.
- AMS shall be reviewed annually for updates by the respective asset owners and any significant changes are to be notified to ISMC by Asset owners.
- AMS review should take into consideration the following steps:
    - Verification of asset numbers in the AMS to ensure asset numbers are aligned with the Asset naming guidelines.
    - Verification of the asset numbers/labeling in the data center; and
    - Cross-validation of AMS and data center assets.
- For a more comprehensive understanding of AMS, please refer to the XYZ-TS ***Asset Management System (AMS) Operational Manual.***

5.1. Asset Onboarding Process

- Initiate the Asset Onboarding process either by submitting an Asset Onboarding Ticket or supplier provided details by email. Ensure that all required details are accurately provided, including relevant documentation, terms and conditions, and any specific asset-related information necessary for the onboarding process. For a comprehensive understanding of the

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required steps and additional guidelines, please refer to the ***Operation Guide for Asset Onboarding*** document.

6. Intellectual Property Rights Protection

In the case of software where intellectual property rights are to be protected:

- The asset owner shall ensure that the maximum number of users permitted is not exceeded.
- Control measures and documented procedures should be followed to ensure the integrity of intellectual property;
- All regulatory requirements on intellectual property rights shall be reviewed by the Information Security Officer (ISO) with the respective division head and approved by the ISMC via email, to which this provision applies. This may be applicable in cases of regulations, or contractual agreements with clients and vendors are in place.
- All software must be genuine and properly licensed when purchased as applicable. Users must strictly abide by the copyright laws and restrictions detailed by the software manufacturer and country legislations.
- A formally approved software whitelist shall be maintained. This whitelist will comprehensively detail all software applications authorized for installation.
- Users are not allowed to install any software that is not approved by Governance & SOC. Permission shall be granted after considering the business requirement of using and the security stability of such software.
- To ensure adherence to the approved software whitelist and compliance with licensing agreements, XYZ-TS will conduct periodic reviews of software installations on all corporate IT assets, including desktops, laptops, servers, and other devices.
- All software found in violation shall be removed immediately. Parties responsible for loading and/or using non-compliant software shall be subject to disciplinary actions.

7. Asset Management Roles and Responsibilities

7.1. Information Asset Owner

The information asset owner has the responsibility of classifying the asset based on XYZ-TS's asset classification scheme.

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- The owner of the information asset shall identify/approve the controls to be implemented to provide appropriate protection to the asset. In addition, the asset owner should annually review the access control policies and classification procedures. The owner of the information asset is accountable for the security of the information asset.
- The Information Asset Owner possesses the authority to make informed decisions regarding the risks associated with the utilization of an information asset.
- Responsibilities of the Information asset owner include:
    - Conduct an analysis and assign an initial information classification based on the criteria in Section 8 of this procedure,
    - Periodically review the classification to ensure it meets business needs, and ensure, in conjunction with the Information Asset Custodian, that security controls are in place commensurate with the classification;
    - Review and ensure appropriate access rights for various types of users associated with the information asset(s) are current;
    - Determine requirements for security, access criteria, user training, retention (aligned with business requirements), disposal, emergency changes, incident handling, and backups for the information assets they own; and
    - Identify/approve the controls to be implemented to provide appropriate protection to the asset.
    - Each information asset owner should review the information, which needs to be archived or deleted. The information asset owner should ensure that the applicable data is archived or deleted appropriately;

7.2. Information Asset Custodian

The custodian of the information asset should be responsible for the protection of the asset by implementing the controls (as identified and approved by the owner of the information asset) and ensuring that protection mechanisms are in place for the classified assets.

- Responsibilities of information asset custodians include:

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- Work with the Information asset owner to conduct a security risk analysis for information assets or when there is any change to the security of existing assets;
- Implement the controls specified by the Information asset owner and as defined in the information security policies and procedures.
- Notify the Information asset owner of security risks that develop and incidents that occur.

7.3. Information Asset User

A user could be an employee, contractor, service provider, vendor, or another third party with a business need to access the information asset concerned. As information is important throughout XYZ-TS, all XYZ-TS users have an important role to play as well as a responsibility to protect the information entrusted to them. All XYZ-TS users who may come into contact with sensitive information are expected to familiarize themselves with this information classification policy and the standards and guidelines supporting it and to consistently use them. Information asset users are individuals who have been granted authorization to access, modify, delete, and/or utilize information by the relevant information asset owner.
The following guidelines shall be followed by the information asset owners during the classification of data:

- Each information asset owner should classify the data into the categories given in the XYZ-TS ***Information Risk Assessment and Treatment procedure*** (XYZ-TS-IS-RG-001).
- Each information asset owner should review the information, which needs to be archived and deleted. The information asset owner should ensure that the applicable data is archived/ deleted appropriately.
- Information asset owners will ensure that XYZ-TS users are familiar with information asset usage guidelines and that the assets are used for business purposes only.
- Any changes to the assets must be reported to the asset owner.

Responsibilities of information asset users include:

- Use the information only for the purposes intended and specifically approved by the information asset owner;
- Comply with all security measures defined by the information asset owner, implemented by the custodian, and/or defined by XYZ-TS policies and procedures; and

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- Report to the custodian, regarding all events where an information security vulnerability or violation may exist.

8. Information Asset Classification

- All information assets, regardless of format or location, necessitate the designation of an information classification level by the designated Information Asset Owner.
- Subsequently, the Information Custodian, in collaboration with the Owner, will implement and/or assign appropriate labeling reflecting the assigned classification level as applicable.
- Classification of information applies to all information in any format (physical or digital), including all software, hardware, and services performed by third parties.
- The information that should be classified includes assets, whether stored, processed, or managed by XYZ-TS, or by a third party.

8.1. Assessing the information asset classification

- XYZ-TS shall employ a three-tiered information asset classification process to categorize assets based on their relative value and potential impact on the organization's security posture. The classification levels are designated as "High," "Medium," and "Low," determined through a comprehensive assessment based on their effect on Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability.
- This assessment will be documented within the AMS using a designated scale of 1 to 3, with higher values reflecting a greater emphasis on the specific CIA principle.
- Asset value = Max (C, I, A).

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Information assets will be classified after calculating the asset value given in the below table;

Factors/Assigned Value	High (3)	Medium (2)	Low (1)
Confidentiality	The asset contains sensitive information that can be shared with only a designated individual or group.	The asset contains information that can be shared among XYZ-TS staff.	The asset contains publicly available information.
Integrity	Contains information that should be accurate and complete at all times and where business functions depend on the same. Any changes done to this information may have a significant impact on the IT business process.	Contains information that should be accurate and complete at an acceptable level and where business functions depend on the same. Any changes done to this information may have a moderate impact on the IT business process.	Even the information does not have to be accurate or complete as less dependency on the information.
Availability	Information assets shall be available at all times.	The unavailability of the information asset is	The unavailability of the information asset is
		Acceptable for up to 2 days.	Acceptable for more than 2 days.

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8.2. Assessing the sensitivity classification of assets

XYZ-TS will use an information classification scheme consisting of 3 classes – Confidential, Internal, and Public. This scheme will be applied as per the following definitions.

	Classification	Definition	Examples
Critical	- Confidential Internal	This information is restricted to selected Individuals or groups of authorized people within XYZ, Cluster, or SBU.	XYZ Business plans, financial information, Prototypes, Budget schedules, Leadership presentations, IPR, etc.
	Confidential - External	This information is restricted to selected individuals or groups of people externally and internally such as Customers, Suppliers and authorized XYZ users	Customer contract agreements, NDA, Customer costing sheets, Supplier agreements, NDA, Supplier costing sheets
Noncritical	Internal	This Information is internal to XYZ. Restricted to external parties.	ISMS documentation, Company Policy documents, Internal circulars, etc.
	Public	This information can be publicly available to anyone.	Annual reports, press statements, company's web page, etc.

8.3. Reassessing Information Assets Classification

All information should be re-assessed annually to verify that they are properly classified. Information can be changed to another classification with time-based on the criticality, therefore appropriate protection of controls should be implemented as per the classification.

8.4. Declassification/Downgrading Information Assets

The following guidelines may be followed by the information asset owners for the declassification/ downgrading of the information assets:

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- The designated asset owner may declassify or downgrade asset value with the consultation of the ISO. To achieve this, the owner shall change the classification label appearing on the original document or asset and notify all known recipients/users.
- The date from which the confidential information will be declassified or downgraded shall be indicated on the sensitive information.
- The ISO may, at any time before scheduled declassification or downgrading, extend the period that information is to remain at a certain classification level.

8.5. Application of Classification

- In all cases where there are multiple levels of classification, the highest classification applies.
- Classified information must not be changed to or moved to a system or environment with a lower classification level without prior authorization by the information asset owner.

8.6. Classification Labeling

- Data classification levels above “public” must be marked or communicated with the material to which it applies as outlined in the table below.
- The information asset owner has the discretion to implement additional classification modifiers to further restrict disclosure beyond the designated level. These modifiers can limit access to specific audiences within XYZ or designate the information for exclusive use within a particular project. Examples include "XYZ Technical Services Only," "Project Team [Name] Only," or "Not to be Copied Further."

8.7. Implementation Considerations

Item	Should the item be labeled with the Classification level?
E-mails	Yes
External storage media (e.g., tapes, USB devices)	Yes
Physical Documents (e.g., letters to Clients, employee files)	Yes
Internal “Office” and similar documents (e.g., word processing, spreadsheets, presentations, diagrams)	Yes
Postal mail (Promotional brochures)	No

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Item	Should the item be labeled with the Classification level?
Postal mail (Credential maintenance, Company statements)	Yes

9. Access to sensitive information

Access to sensitive information may be granted to individuals (both internal and external) who do not under normal operations require access to such information. Such access will only be granted based on the following:

- A formal access request will be submitted by the requestor's immediate supervisor.
- The Information Asset owner shall review and approve the access request based on the following:
  - The requested access is required to perform the business duties;
  - The requested access is in line with the principle of least privileges;
  - A formal non-disclosure agreement is in effect around the parties accessed; and
  - The risk highlighted is acceptable for the asset owner.
- This process shall adhere to the additional guidelines stated in the system access control procedure.

10. Information Handling

Access to Information shall be provided on a need-to-know and need-to-use basis by its classification. Appropriate control measures shall be applied to protect the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of the information.

10.1. Storage and Transfer of Confidential Information

10.1.1. Hard Copies

While in use, it is the responsibility of the information asset owner and the asset user to ensure that the information is not disclosed to unauthorized people.

Physical documents shall be appropriately labeled according to the information contained within them.

Sensitivity Classification with "Confidential" documents shall be given an asset value of "High" and "Internal" documents given an asset value of "Medium". Sensitivity Classification with "Public

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or No classification" documents shall be given asset values of "Low" depending on the Confidentiality, Integrity, and Availability factors and shall be labeled accordingly.

These documents shall be kept in a properly secured environment to prevent unauthorized or accidental disclosure.

Envelopes of letters containing "Confidential" documents shall be labeled with a "Confidential" stamp/label accordingly.

10.1.2. Electronic Copies

XYZ-TS personnel are responsible for adhering to all relevant laws, directives, and mandates concerning electronic data retention and destruction.
By these legal and regulatory requirements, XYZ-TS data owners will define retention periods within a designated Data Retention Schedule.

Electronic copies of "Confidential" information shall be password-protected and encrypted by XYZ-TS standards.
Storage of "confidential" documents on removable media is not encouraged. However, if removable media is used, for the transfer of such documents removable media shall be appropriately protected with a password or any other encryption method. After the transfer, all documents shall be deleted from the removable media.
The user is responsible for protecting files containing "Confidential" information using passwords and/or appropriate encryption mechanisms.
While transferring "Confidential" documents through e-mail, the information shall be password protected.

10.2. Destruction of Confidential Records

All "Confidential" and "Internal" paper documents shall be shredded with a paper shredder.

Information disposal can only proceed after a verification ensuring compliance with all applicable legal, regulatory, and contractual retention requirements. Where there is no specific reference to such requirement, those should correspond with their respective hard copy retention periods.

All remains shall be properly disposed of.

Electronic media shall be overwritten, destroyed, or otherwise rendered useless.

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10.3. Document Formats

	Public	Internal	Confidential
Mandatory Cover Page – Where applicable		X	X
Classification on Cover Page – Where applicable		X	X
Classification on Footer or Header or/and electronic tagging	X	X	X
Confidential Disclaimer			X
Document Expiry date – Where applicable	X	X	X

11. Information Handling

11.1. Information Handling Matrix

Activity	Asset Type	Information Classification		
		Low	Medium	High
Labeling	Digital Assets (Soft copy Documents)	No restrictions.	Shall be labeled as "Internal". The label will be included in the header of the document.	Shall be labeled as "Confidential". The label will be included in the header of the document.
	Physical Assets (IT Hardware or Printed documents)	The classification of the asset is indicated in the information AMS.	The classification of the asset is indicated in the information AMS.	The classification of the asset is indicated in the information AMS.

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Activity	Asset Type	Information Classification		
		Low	Medium	High
Access and Storage	Digital Asset	No restrictions.	Access levels and granting of access are to be determined by the Asset Owner. Shall be stored in an access-controlled system. Backup frequencies and methods shall be determined as per the Backup and Recovery procedure.	Access levels and granting of access are to be determined by the Asset Owner. Shall be stored in an access-controlled system. Backup frequencies and methods shall be determined as per Backup and Recovery procedure.

Activity	Asset Type	Information Classification

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		Low	Medium	High
	Physical Assets	No restrictions.	Granting of access to be determined by the Asset Owner, Respective Division Head. Physical assets should be locked when not in use. If a staff member sees an asset that has been left open and unattended, the staff member has to notify the Asset Owner. If the Asset Owner is unavailable, the staff member has to secure the data and inform the Asset Custodian.	Granting of access to be determined by the Asset Owner. Asset owners have to determine the retention period of the asset. Physical assets should be locked when not in use. If a staff member sees an asset that has been left in the open and unattended, the staff member has to notify the asset owner. If the Asset Owner is unavailable, the staff member has to secure the data and advise the Asset Owner.

Activity	Asset Type	Information Classification		
		Low	Medium	High

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Transmission	Digital Assets	No restrictions	When transmitting digital assets, the asset should be encrypted/ password protected wherever possible. Never send a password-protected document, and the password, in the same email.	When transmitting digital assets, the asset should be encrypted/ password protected at all times. Never send a password-protected document, and the password, in the same email.
Declassification	Physical and Digital Assets	This will be done by the asset owner as and when needed.	This will be done by the asset owner as and when needed.	This will be done by the asset owner as and when needed. Should obtain the approval from the ISMC.
Destruction	Digital Assets	An asset that is not needed should be deleted.	Shall be carried out as per the media handling procedure.	Shall be carried out as per the media handling procedure.
	Physical Assets (paper and other physical data)	No restrictions.	Paper documents or physical data should always be shredded.	Paper documents or physical data should always be shredded.

Activity	Asset Type	Information Classification		
		Low	Medium	High

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	Single Disk being a part of a split volume	No restrictions.	Should be verified and authorized by the ISO and can be returned to the manufacturer to claim warranty	Should be verified and authorized by the ISO and can be returned to the manufacturer to claim warranty
	Single or multiple disks containing the entire set of data	No restrictions.	Physical destruction or wiping off data	Physical destruction or wiping off data
Processing	Physical and Digital Assets	No restrictions.	When working with or processing data, staff should always be vigilant that unauthorized personnel do not have access to the data.	Staff should ensure that unauthorized personnel do not have access.

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11.2. Change of Classification

The document owner may initiate a reclassification process to change the assigned classification level of an information asset. This action requires prior approval from the IS Officer.

11.3. Voice

11.3.1. Mobile telephones

- XYZ-TS employees must manage conversations to prevent unauthorized disclosure of confidential information during communications via mobile devices.

11.3.2. Telephone Conferencing

- Confidential discussions should be limited to locations with approved conferencing facilities.
- Where necessary, transcription and call recording should be used with caution.

11.3.3. Printing Confidential Information

- Confidential documents shall not be printed on publicly accessible printers without the direct supervision of the IS Officer.
- Secure print method must be used wherever feasible.

12. Introduction of Crown Jewel Assets

As it is practically impossible to protect every component of an organization's IT infrastructure against a possible cyber-attack, the identification of the most important components seems to be the most logical thing to do to help the cybersecurity teams focus their (rather limited) efforts and resources effectively and efficiently. The crown jewels assets are XYZ's most prized and valuable assets. The crown jewels may be physical assets or intangibles like patents intellectual property and trade secrets. XYZ critical information assets are defined based on their:

- Significance to the business.
- Value to an attacker
- Associated business impact if compromised.

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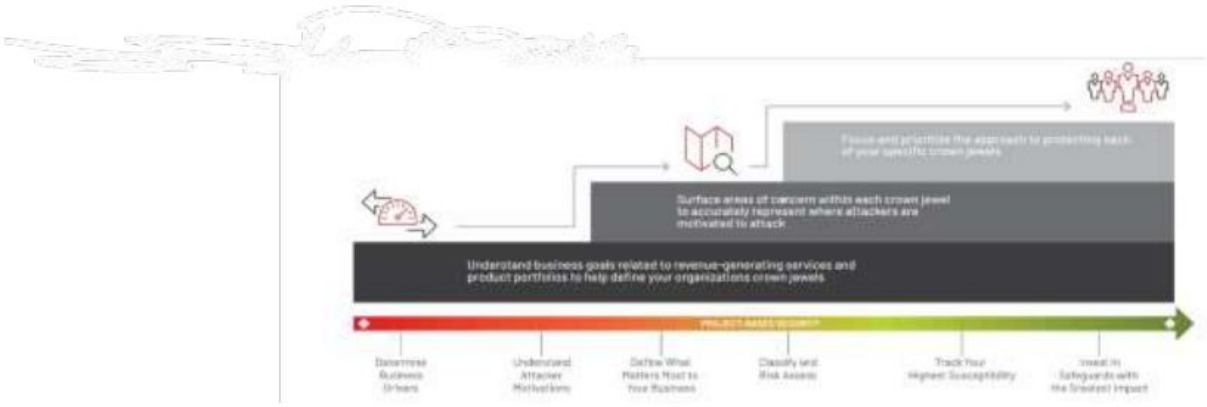


Figure 1: Service Approach Overview

- A quarterly risk assessment should be conducted to identify risks about Crown Jewel assets by the process owners.

13. Latest Version of This Document

You can obtain the latest version of this document from the CDO.

14. Key Roles & Responsibility

- The Chief Digital Officer (CDO) shall be accountable for the effective review, approval, communication, implementation, and adoption and all changes to the procedure.
- The Head of IT security shall own and be responsible for the accuracy and maintenance of this procedure as well as its effective communication and implementation.
- All IT employees across XYZ Holdings shall support the effective adoption and implementation of this procedure.

15. Compliance and Disciplinary Action

- Systems and services provided by XYZ-TS are the property of XYZ-TS. This gives XYZ-TS the right to monitor all activities performed using these resources.
- Users shall maintain continued compliance with all XYZ-TS policies, procedures, guidelines, rules, and administrative orders while using XYZ-TS systems, facilities, and/or services.
- The Chief Digital Officer shall designate persons to perform periodic reviews and provide relevant feedback on the design and operating effectiveness of this procedure.
- Non-compliance to this procedure shall be recorded and responded to through the Incident and Problem Management procedure.
- If XYZ-TS discovers or has good reason to suspect activities that do not comply with applicable laws or policies, activity logs or records may be retrieved and used/ presented as evidence for disciplinary action against the involved user.

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